

AFTER HERMAN MELVILLE'S *Moby-Dick*

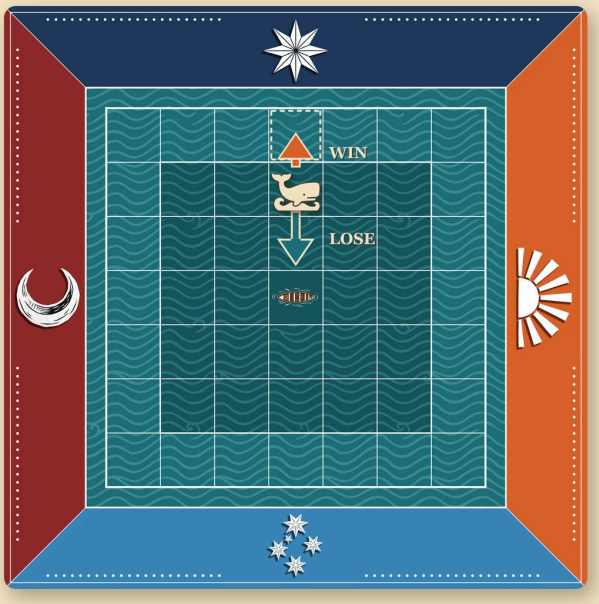
Ahab and the Whale

Lead and win, go forward. Lead and lose, go backwards.

IT'S LIKE
Jekyll vs. Hyde, played across a sea chart

2	~10	~1.8	10+
PLAYERS	MINUTES	BGG WEIGHT (EST.)	AGES

PROTOTYPE ART





One trick: a North 7 is led and a North 4 follows. The leader wins, so the whale goes forward, north onto open sea. Had the follower played an 8, the leader would have lost and the whale gone backwards, south.

About the Game

The hunt for Moby Dick as a tug-of-war at sea, played with cards.

Every trick drags the whale a step. Ahab hauls it in towards his harpoon; the Whale pulls it out to open sea.

Features

- **Multi-use cards.** Each card is trick strength, a wind and, when you can't follow suit, a rudder.
- **Balanced asymmetry.** Two roles with opposite goals, tuned so neither side has the edge.
- **Nothing to track.** No trumps, no bidding, no scoring: the whale's position is the score.
- **Down to the wire.** The whale keeps coming within a step of open sea, and the last tricks decide it.

The Chase, Trick by Trick



Lead the wind

Your suit is a compass wind. It picks the line: North–South or East–West.



Win it or lose it

Leader wins: the whale goes forward with the wind. Follower wins: it goes backwards.



Can't follow? Steer

You lose the trick, but the whale moves the way of the card you throw.



Caught or free

After twelve tricks: inside, Ahab's harpoon strikes. On the outer ring, the whale swims free.

CONTENTS 36 wind cards (A–9 in four suits) · 1 sea chart · 1 wooden whale · 2 player aids

STATUS Public-domain theme, no licence needed · balanced in bot simulation · first table tests under way · all art prototype-placeholder

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